25900434 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCHIS201 - UNDERSTANDING EARLY INDIA

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Briefly describe the origins and major locations of the Indus Valley Civilization, naming at least two important sites. [K] / [CO1]
2. Write a short note on the art and religious cults practiced during the Neolithic Age in the Indian Subcontinent. [K] / [CO1]
3. Summarize how the Satavahanas ruled in the Deccan. [U] / [CO1]
4. Examine how bali payments helped Vedic leaders collect resources. [An] / [CO2]
5. Break down the feudalism debate to understand Gupta land grants. [An] / [CO2]
6. Evaluate the contribution of agricultural practices to the social structure of the Malwa culture. [E] / [CO3]
7. Analyse how Indica describes daily life in Mauryan society. [An] / [CO3]
8. Judge the significance of Gupta stupas in spreading Buddhist ideas. [E] / [CO3]
9. Examine how jati hierarchies shaped social roles during the Gupta period. [An] / [CO2]

10. Use Vedic texts to show how Indo-Aryans settled in the North-West of the Subcontinent. [A] / [CO5]

11. Use Buddhist teachings to explain how they guided people's lives. [A] / [CO5]

12. Briefly explain the evidence of human evolution in the Indian Subcontinent, mentioning key fossil finds or archaeological sites. [K] / [CO1]

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

SHORT ESSAY

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. Explain the change from a pastoral lifestyle to a settled farming life during the Vedic period. [U] / [CO1]

14. How did the movement of Indo-Aryans from the Northwest to the Doab region change the cultural landscape? [An] / [CO2]

15. Discuss the features of viharas, stupas, and cave art in the context of Gupta art and architecture. [An] / [CO2]

16. Explain the key aspects of administration in the Mauryan Empire as described in Kautilya's Arthashastra. [An] / [CO3]

17. Evaluate how the crystallization of jati shaped social life in the Gupta and post-Gupta periods. [E] / [CO3]

18. Do you agree that the South Indian Chalcolithic communities made good use of their environment? Explain. [E] / [CO4]

19. Use the idea of big rivers like the Indus to show how early people picked spots to build their homes. [A] / [CO5]

20. Apply your understanding of heterodox sects to highlight one way Jainism and Buddhism differed from Vedic orthodoxy. [A] / [CO5]

21. What roles did Sabha, Samiti, and Vidhata play in early political life? [U] / [CO1]

22. What do changing roles of Sabha, Samiti, and Vidhata tell us about political evolution in early Vedic times? [An] / [CO2]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

ESSAY QUESTION

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

23. Write an essay on the Mesolithic age in India, with reference to tool traditions and main sites. [K] / [CO1]

24. Explain the different perspectives of the Aryan Debate to show how historians interpret the arrival of the Indo-Aryans. [U] / [CO1]

25. Analyse the relationship between systems of knowledge, literature, and religious thought in the Gupta age. [An] / [CO2]

26. Apply your understanding of political structures to illustrate the differences between kingdoms and Ganasanghas in the Mahajanapada period. [A] / [CO5]

[10x2 = 20]